Design Sprint

Answer a big question in five days: map the problem, sketch ideas, decide, build a realistic prototype and test it with customers.

Decide What to Build · Design Sprint (Jake Knapp, GV) · Map · Sketch · Decide · Prototype · Test

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

SPRINT: Staples subscriptions
DATES: 9–13 June
DECIDER: Priya

1 Challenge & Goal — MONDAY MORNING

The challenge: would families set up a staples subscription, and keep it?

Long-term goal (in two years…): 1 in 4 weekly shoppers has a staples subscription

Sprint questions (what could stop us?): will they trust auto-add? Can they change it easily? Will it feel like a lock-in?

2 The Sprint Team — SEVEN OR FEWER

Decider: Priya
Facilitator: Tom
Customer expert: customer service lead
Tech expert: Sam
Design: Mei
Business / money: Finance partner

3 Map — MONDAY

- Agree the long-term goal
- Map the customer journey
- Ask the experts; note “How might we…?”
- Pick a target on the map

WHAT WE PRODUCED

Journey: pick staples → set day → skip a week

HMW make skipping easy?

Our target: first set-up and the first skip

4 Sketch — TUESDAY

- Lightning demos of existing ideas
- Sketch solutions alone, in four steps
- Recruit five customers for Friday

WHAT WE PRODUCED

Sketch: a staples shelf

Sketch: a “usual” toggle

Sketches made: 7 four-step sketches

5 Decide — WEDNESDAY

- Silent gallery and heat-map dots
- Straw poll, then the Decider chooses
- Storyboard the prototype

WHAT WE PRODUCED

Heat-map dots on the toggle

Storyboard: 8 frames

Winning idea: a “usual” toggle, skip anytime

6 Prototype — THURSDAY

- Build a realistic façade, not the product
- Split roles: makers, writer, stitcher
- Trial run; write the interview script

WHAT WE PRODUCED

Clickable mock-up in a day

Interview script

Prototype is a: clickable mobile mock-up

7 Test — FRIDAY

- Five one-to-one customer interviews
- The team watches and takes notes
- Look for patterns across interviews

WHAT WE PRODUCED

4 of 5 set it up unaided

“Skip” was hard to find

Patterns we saw: trust needs an easy skip

8 Friday's Results — ✓ WORKED · ✗ DIDN'T · ? UNCLEAR

SPRINT QUESTION OR TARGET	CUSTOMER 1	CUSTOMER 2	CUSTOMER 3	CUSTOMER 4	CUSTOMER 5
Families set it up without help	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
They feel in control (skip, change)	?	✗	✓	✗	?
They'd pay for it each week	✓	?	✓	✓	✗

9 What Next? — THE DECIDER CALLS IT

- [ ] Build it
- [x] Iterate and test again
- [ ] Change direction
- [ ] Stop here

First step and owner: make skip one tap, test again on 20 June: Mei

“What question, if answered on Friday, would make this week worth it?”

“What did customers do, not just say?”

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